Apalutamide: prostate cancer with ongoing ADT

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00574 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before starting

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests and thyroid function; electrocardiogram (ECG) if at risk of heart-rhythm changes; international normalised ratio (blood-clotting test) (INR) if taking warfarin. Review cardiovascular and seizure history, falls, bone health and all medicines.

STEP 2

Taking or receiving treatment

Take at the same time each day, with or without food. Swallow tablets whole with water. If a dose is missed, take it as soon as possible that day and return to the usual schedule the next day; never take extra tablets to make up a dose. If you cannot swallow the tablet, a pharmacist must teach the correct preparation for your 60 mg or 240 mg formulation or feeding tube.

STEP 3

Tests and reviews

Repeat blood count, kidney and liver tests on the schedule agreed with your team. Thyroid function and ECG as clinically indicated. If warfarin is unavoidable, INR weekly until the dose is stable. The NCCP regimen does not set one fixed interval for every routine blood test.

STEP 4

Specific practical instructions

Report rash promptly. Blisters, peeling skin, fever with rash, or mouth/eye sores need immediate medical advice. New or worsening cough or breathlessness requires urgent assessment for lung inflammation. Seizures require emergency help. Discuss driving and medicine interactions.

STEP 5

Leaving with a clear plan

Confirm the next appointment, dose, support medicines and verified daytime and out-of-hours phone numbers.

Sources: NCCP 00574 v5: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.